MERIDIAN MUSEUM / 2026

Artie Ficial

IF INNOCENT: I did not kill Grant. My refusal was already with the board, and the preview photograph shows the bottle I foolishly allowed to remain on display. I relied on an instruction to keep it closed. Claire will have every reason to ask why. Tomorrow I have to tell the staff what happened in the institution I promised to protect. Tonight, for once, somebody else can make the closing remarks.

IF MURDERER: I killed Grant. The refusal in the announcement folder was real. So was the bottle at the preview. I took its poison and later went to his waiting private glass. The public argument gave everyone something else to watch. I told you intake had removed the bottle because I wanted that opportunity gone from your account of the evening. The wide photograph put it back. I cannot call this protecting the museum. Claire will have to tell the staff what I did, and I will not be here to make it sound dignified.

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Claire O’Scuro

IF INNOCENT: I did not kill Grant. Intake retained the unanswered contents question and the closed-bottle restriction. I left the preview approved anyway. My earlier bowl label was also wrong. Reed, you should not have needed my permission to keep asking. I cannot offer you a corrected label as an apology for that. I can offer you the original file, and I can stop standing between you and it.

IF MURDERER: The incoming sheet does not say empty. It says inert display liquid, on Grant's word. I moved the papers because I did not want that distinction examined. I took poison from the bottle during the preview and later put it in his waiting glass. I used my authority over intake to make the source sound harmless and nonexistent. My label correction was real. Reed, you were right to question me. I have spent tonight making you ashamed of the person who taught you to do that.

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Hugh Bidder

IF INNOCENT: I did not kill Grant. The seller attachment was unaltered when I sent it to intake before the gala. I still sold the bowl under a false certificate, changed our file, and repeated Grant's harmless-liquid claim without resolving it. He deserved the refund. Elon, you deserve to see your purchase files. I dislike the man Saul thinks I am. I have given him a very good case tonight.

IF MURDERER: I killed Grant. The original-contents condition was never canceled. I had arranged the purchase; I knew what had been required. During the closed preview I took poison from that bottle. Later, while the private glass was unattended, I used it. The harmless-substitution story was the cover I gave you. The executed sale, seller's statement and residue findings contradicted it. His refund demand on the bowl would have finished my firm. I could have faced the bad sale and the file alteration. Saul can have the clients. Elon can have every file. I wanted so badly to remain the respectable man behind that desk that I have made him impossible to remember.

Monet Bags

IF INNOCENT: I did not kill Grant. My ticket went back through the manager; the paid toast continued. The restricted money went to wages. That doesn't authorize what I did. The board will have the whole account. I want someone to tell the staff before they read about it. They shouldn't spend tomorrow wondering whether their next paycheck is another promise from somebody in this room.

IF MURDERER: I killed Grant. The accounts argument happened, and I sent the ticket back with the manager. My separate visit to find Grant was after the preview, while his unwrapped glass was waiting. I used poison I'd taken from the bottle. I told you that visit was before the preview; the manager had not even set out the glass then. I had already used restricted money for payroll. Grant wanted to examine the books and control the rescue. The wages were paid. That is the small fact I kept hiding behind. A family is waiting for a man who will never come home, and I made that happen.

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Chip Patina

IF INNOCENT: I did not poison Grant. I changed an insurance date. I also put a foil-backed paper band on a closed bottle and missed the later split at its back. My original sheet and photograph remain. Claire, I will give you the keys to the workbench. I keep objects safe by refusing to let anyone near them. Tonight that instinct failed the people who trusted me.

IF MURDERER: The red band was foil-backed paper, exactly as the report says. I denied my own material because I had opened the bottle during the preview. I knew where its closure was weakest. Later I put the stolen poison in Grant's private glass. Its scrap and the damaged band belong to that sequence; they are not a unique fingerprint, and I hoped you would stop at that objection. The false date gave him leverage over me. I used the weakness in a closure I had fitted. People trusted my hands near things that could not be replaced. They should never trust them again.

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Dada DiCapo

IF INNOCENT: I planned an insult. The delivered film and Grant's rejection tell you what it was: an empty jacket, no live performer. I pushed the coordinator and went to his room because I wanted it shown. I did not kill him. Vincent, please don't tell me I can make work about this. I know. I am going to need a very long time before I want to.

IF MURDERER: There was no agreed live fall. Grant's rejection meant what it said. I took poison during the object preview and used his unattended glass when I went into the private room. Then I told you his death began as an approved stunt. The film gave that lie something visible to lean on. It was an empty jacket in a chair, not consent to what I did to him. He took my name off his show. Vincent, there is no artistic explanation that makes this better. I kept wanting the room to look at my work. Now everyone is looking at what I did.

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Vincent Van Faux

IF INNOCENT: I did not kill Grant. My model was wood; the loan was glass. The delivery list separates the painting from the object. I withdrew reproduction permission even with payment outstanding. I also let Grant sell a grander story about my early work than it deserved. Dada, I owe you a conversation without collectors listening. Bring the bad student paintings. I could stand to remember what trying felt like.

IF MURDERER: I killed Grant. The preview bottle was his acquired original, not my studio model. I used the model story to make the source sound harmless. I took poison during the preview and later put it in his waiting glass. My delivery list never included a model; the intake photograph showed his bottle. He had bought a picture. Dada kept making work. I kept wanting someone else to remove the man who made me feel small. There is no picture I can paint that excuses doing it myself.

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Sue Venir

IF INNOCENT: I did not kill Grant. I took the master at the public desk, and private service continued. My objection reached the board with the bad advice still attached. I should have challenged that ownership file sooner. Mona, tomorrow I will argue the authority of your letter again. Tonight I would like to go home with my friend. Neither of us has to win that conversation.

IF MURDERER: I killed Grant. Removing the public announcement copy was real. My separate visit to his private place was not supervised. I took his donor copy and contaminated the waiting glass with poison I'd taken during the preview. I invented the pour beside me to put a witness in that room. The manager poured in the kitchen, after collecting the glass. Grant had my advice attached to the ownership file. He could expose what I had approved. Mona, I have made it impossible for you to sit beside me without wondering what I could do. That is worse than losing any case.

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Dr. Art E. Fact

IF INNOCENT: I did not kill Grant. My dated query quotes the contents condition; intake answered that it remained unresolved. I let the entry proceed. Reed, your finding deserves your name. Dada, the invitation to dinner I kept disguising as a discussion of your work was an invitation to dinner. You need not answer it tonight. I am trying to say one thing without a footnote.

IF MURDERER: I had read the condition. My own query quotes it. I denied that knowledge because it explained why I knew the bottle might still hold its original contents. I took the poison during the preview and used it in Grant's private glass. The ownership correction was not going to stop him circulating my mistake. I decided to stop him instead. I have spent a career distinguishing an object from the story sold with it. Dada, you need not explain your work to me. Reed, you need never seek my approval. I have used my knowledge for the smallest possible purpose.

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Tess Tament

IF INNOCENT: I did not poison Grant. The draft shows I asked for the family appointment while he was alive; the board had not accepted the gift. His glass was already bare when I left my card. I do inherit. I was angry. Hugh, please don't tell me how fortunate that makes me. I have an argument waiting for someone who will never answer it, and I still want him to answer.

IF MURDERER: I killed Grant. His glass was already unwrapped when I left the seating card. I used poison I'd taken during the preview, then told you the shop wrapping had stayed on until the manager poured. The manager's account left an unattended glass where my account put a wrapped present. I ordered that glass and arranged the room. I knew how ordinary my visit would look. I wanted his authority without having to keep asking him for it. The agreement was still unsigned. I wanted him to hear me as an adult. Now every room in that family house will remind me of the person I made sure could never answer.

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Barb Dwyer

IF INNOCENT: I did not kill Grant. I ordered the power removed and lied in the log. The technician's work order carries my signature. My own department created a blind spot. I will return the badge while that is investigated. Brie, make sure your staff get home before anybody starts asking them for a convenient version of tonight. They don't owe the museum one.

IF MURDERER: I turned recording off. The signed work order removes power, not a network lead. I checked the room so I knew where Grant's glass was waiting. I had already taken poison during the preview; I used it at that private place. Then I relied on the privacy exception to conceal the visit. I told you a local recording existed because I wanted the missing footage to sound like a problem we could fix. There is no footage to find. I used a blind spot I created. My department will have to answer for trusting the person who was supposed to keep it honest.

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Paige Turner

IF INNOCENT: I did not kill Grant. The untrimmed opening places our interview at his private table tonight. My editor had that original; I cut the employee's voice from the export. The correction will run. The source's name won't. I also need to ask that person what they want now. I have spent too much of this investigation treating being protected and being useful to me as the same thing.

IF MURDERER: I killed Grant. The original opening put me at his private place during this reception, while the service manager was setting the glass. That was the visit my office-yesterday account tried to erase. I'd taken poison from the bottle during the closed preview and used it in the unattended glass. I cut the exchange from the export; the editor still had the original. The employee's voice was a reason to protect part of that recording. I used it as cover for concealing my own access. Grant wanted a source's name. My source never asked me to do this. I turned protecting someone into permission to decide everything for them.

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Frank Lloyd Wrong

IF INNOCENT: I did not kill Grant. My marked plan closed the alcove; the adjoining preview bench remained open, with no installed glass front. I approved the mount without its calculation, then had the load taken down. Elle, take your work when it can be moved safely. Minnie, leave the empty space. People may see that something I designed had to be stopped.

IF MURDERER: I killed Grant. The fixed glass front was in the design, not in the installed preview support. The wide image and installation revision show an open bench. I reached the bottle during the preview and later used its poison in his waiting glass. I offered you the approved drawing as though it were the built room. Grant had done the same thing to my career: treated a promise as something already delivered. I offered you a drawing in place of a room. Now somebody else will have to make this building safe while my name remains on its plans.

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Mona Lott

IF INNOCENT: I did not kill Grant. He drank the toast; the water I requested stayed sealed. My claim letter overstated its authority, and Tess deserved to know about my commission. I withdrew the bead recommendation. Sue, I would like you to come with me when I explain the letter to the claimants. They may choose someone else. Please let that be their choice, even if it costs me my place.

IF MURDERER: I killed Grant. He accepted the toast. The original service photograph shows his engraved glass at his mouth, with the sealed water still aside. I poisoned the waiting glass using what I had taken at the preview. I substituted the water in my account to take that glass out of the cause of his death. Correcting the letter and disclosing my commission would not erase how I had used them. Sue, the claimants asked for an advocate. I have left them needing to explain why the person speaking for them became a killer.

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Elon Mosaic

IF INNOCENT: I did not kill Grant. My panel was a saved picture; the camera had no power. The trial credit does not turn that demonstration into a working installation. Monet, next time I will bring the technician who has to build it. Hugh, tell me which purchases need checking. I am tired of pretending that asking somebody who knows more would make me less impressive.

IF MURDERER: I killed Grant. There was no live platform view. The camera had no power, and my panel was a saved image. I took poison during the preview and later used his private glass. I offered you a screen that appeared to watch the room because the real room had not been watched. Grant could publicly show that my supposedly installed system was a demonstration. I kept presenting things somebody else still had to build. Grant is dead because I couldn't bear letting people see the gap.

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Anya Tique

IF INNOCENT: I did not kill Grant. My key worked, and I used it without asking. My withdrawn policy is still in the file beside the later replacement. I hid the part of our history that embarrassed me. Artie, here is the spare. I would like an invitation to the next board discussion, if there is one. I would rather be asked to come than let myself in.

IF MURDERER: The key works. I used it when I returned the memo after the preview. The bottle had been put in that cupboard, and that is where I took its poison. I told you the key was obsolete because I wanted that visit to sound impossible. Later I used the poison in Grant's waiting glass. A display memo was an excuse to enter; it was not what I went back for. I wanted the institution I founded back. I wanted this place to need me again. It will remember me now, and I have no right to ask how.

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Saul D. Bid

IF INNOCENT: I did not kill Grant. The sale withdrawal did not remove the physical loan; the photograph shows it remained. I returned the fee. Hugh, I enjoyed your embarrassment. It was shabby of me. I can apologize for that without endorsing your certificate or asking you to accept mine. We have enough clients to disappoint without inventing another rivalry to feed them.

IF MURDERER: I killed Grant. I withdrew the sale offer, not the bottle. It was there at the preview, where I took its poison. I later used his waiting glass. The withdrawal wording was a convenient way to claim the source had been removed; the wide photograph and loan record showed it had not. I had put my house's authority behind advice I did not want examined. Hugh, you may keep the last word. I have made every future sale beneath my house's name a question about what I did tonight.

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Elle Loominate

IF INNOCENT: I did not kill Grant. The slides show stitches and the preview shows the real bottle. I dismantled my panel because of the lamp. The advance has been repaid; the pattern remains mine. That has not cured the way I spend. Chip, I would like somebody with me when I go through the fabric orders. I will choose what I keep. I need help choosing what I stop buying.

IF MURDERER: I killed Grant. There was no projected bottle in the textile slides. The slide contact sheet shows stitches; the preview image shows the actual glass vessel on its support. I took poison there and used his waiting glass later. I invented the projection to make a real source unreachable. Repaying the other advance did not stop Grant exposing what I had done with it. I can still own the pattern. I will never be able to touch that fabric without remembering the person I decided was the price of keeping it.

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Reed DeLabel

IF INNOCENT: I did not kill Grant. My marked proof sends the complete query to intake and the shortened caption to the press. I removed a warning to finish a page. Claire, I want my work credited. I also want to stop needing your approval to know when something is wrong. Those are separate things. I will send the uncut entry myself, even if nobody thanks me for making it longer.

IF MURDERER: I removed the original-contents sentence. The marked proof is mine. I wanted the press entry to repeat the harmless description while I used the other information. During the preview I took poison from the bottle. Later I put it in Grant's waiting glass. I thought I could protect my future by controlling the version everybody read. I wanted my name on the work. It will be on this instead. Claire cannot revise that for me, and I cannot ask her to.

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Al Baster

IF INNOCENT: I did not kill Grant. The contract bought resin, and the corrected label says resin. My sample is gold leaf; the glass scrap is foil-backed red paper. The reduced settlement cost me. Cary, thanks for not pretending it was bronze while you moved it. I owe an explanation for letting that description stand. First I want to call home. Someone there has been waiting all evening for me.

IF MURDERER: I killed Grant. The fragment was foil-backed paper, not my accent leaf. The sample card made my material story untenable. I had opened the loan bottle during the preview and later used its poison in his glass. I pointed you toward sculpture debris because I didn't want that scrap considered with the damaged closure. It wasn't a unique match, but it wasn't my finish either. Grant could make the publicity fraud the whole story of my work. Somebody at home will be waiting for me. I kept telling myself what they needed justified what I did. They never asked me to bring this into their life.

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Ella Gance

IF INNOCENT: I did not kill Grant. The original photograph is in the public gallery. My withdrawal arrived before the announcement. I tried to make a disputed purchase vanish from a flattering picture. I dislike being embarrassed. I dislike being owned more. Elon, you can keep the society page. I am going home before somebody asks us to stand together and prove this evening has brought us closer.

IF MURDERER: I killed Grant. The photograph was in the public gallery. It did not show my visit to his private place. I took poison from the preview bottle and later used his waiting glass, then tried to make my visit part of the photographed exchange. The original frame showed a different room. My withdrawn endorsement did not take the old approval out of his hands. There will be plenty of pictures of me now. I will have no say in which one people choose to remember.

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Drew Conclusions

IF INNOCENT: I did not kill Grant. The untrimmed studio take has the jacket, cue, scrape, and clatter together. My teaser borrowed that sound. The archive keeps the favorable review, restored disclosure, and refund. Paige, write what you find. I am not going to help by supplying an amusing description of myself. For once I would like to hear the sentence without improving its ending.

IF MURDERER: I killed Grant. The sound came from the studio take, with the empty jacket. There was no earlier collapse of the donor in my recording. I took poison at the preview and used the unattended glass. Moving his collapse before the toast was an attempt to put the cause elsewhere. The untrimmed production source contradicted me. Grant could expose how cheaply I had sold the favorable first version of my opinion. I thought I could control the story by deciding where it began. It begins with a man dead, and I am the reason he is.

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Brie DeVivre

IF INNOCENT: I did not poison Grant. I flavored his individual drink under the paid order. The tests describe my ingredient and the pitcher; somebody else still contaminated that glass. The extra course remains my unpaid purchase. Monet, we will argue about it tomorrow. Tonight my staff need their coats and a lift home. They have earned that even if nobody wants the dinner they made.

IF MURDERER: I killed Grant. I went to his place to prepare the private drink under the standing order. I also used poison from the bottle I'd opened during the closed preview. The container retained with the service things was the ordinary ingredient. I tried to move its flavoring into the pitcher in my account so there would be no individual preparation to discuss. The comparison put the flavoring in his glass, not the pitcher. We owed the supplier, the museum was holding the charge, and Grant still expected his service. My staff kept serving because I told them everything was under control. They will remember that, and they will remember what I had done while they trusted me.

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Cary Crates

IF INNOCENT: I did not kill him. The crest glass went to the manager and appears in the toast photograph. The other frame was intact before my delivery and cracked afterward. I've signed the repair charge. I don't know if I still have the job. Chip can give them my number. I'll answer. Would rather get the call than keep waiting for Grant to decide when to make it.

IF MURDERER: I killed Grant. The engraved glass was unpacked and used. Its crest appears in the service photograph; the manager's receipt accounts for the carton. I stole poison during the preview and later put it in that waiting glass. I called it a spare to disconnect the investigated container from the drink he consumed. Grant could expose my false damage report and force another unsafe signature out of me. I was afraid of losing the job. Nobody's going to ask me to move anything now. That is the smallest part of what I've lost.

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Anne E. Dote

IF INNOCENT: I did not kill Grant. The marked route and assistant docent place our turnback at the public cases. The private room was no tour stop. I used workshop money for a school promise I had no authority to make. The displaced guests deserve their explanation. I will give it. I would rather have them angry at me than teach the children that somebody else always decides whether they belong here.

IF MURDERER: I killed Grant. The approved tour did not include his private room. I used poison from the preview bottle at his unattended place, without my tour group. I later put that visit inside the tour in my account. The marked route excludes the room, and the assistant docent recorded the actual turnback to the public cases. I borrowed a group that had never been beside that glass. Funding the school places did not erase the promise Grant could expose. I promised children a place in this museum. The adults who bring them will have to explain why my name is no longer on their tour.

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Faye Stop

IF INNOCENT: I did not kill Grant. The editor's copied card contains the bottle before my export. The later toast frame shows the glass he used. I let another commercial image be described as editorial; the client now has both versions. I won't ask them to forget it. Ella, choose whichever side you like next time. I would like to take one picture that nobody has negotiated first.

IF MURDERER: I killed Grant. I did not insert the bottle into the preview export. It was in the original frame from the camera, on the actual support. I took its poison during that preview and later used the waiting glass. I tried to turn the strongest ordinary picture of source access into a publicity composite. The picture editor had copied and kept the card before I made the export. That source contradicted my story. Grant had my earlier retouch and the reputation I had built on a cleaner description of it. I kept everyone else's moments and tried to erase my own. There is no crop small enough to remove what I did.

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Robin Banks

IF INNOCENT: I did not kill Grant. The interview opening places my petition at his private table. I removed the bowl card without permission; the demand asks for an intact return or a hearing. It is still unanswered. Anne, if you agree with it, say so where leadership can hear. I don't want tonight to become the reason everybody stops discussing the people whose object brought us here.

IF MURDERER: I delivered the petition at his private place. The recording is right; my public gallery account was not. I had taken poison during the preview. Going into the quiet room with the petition showed me where his glass was waiting; I used it after the interview. The demand called for a hearing and an intact return. It authorized none of what I did. The claimants asked for their bowl and a hearing. I have made them defend themselves against my act. I had no right to do that in their name.

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Penny Pincher

IF INNOCENT: I did not kill Grant. The drawing shows a closure band across the stopper. I was wrong about it. The family settlement pays the difference I withheld; I withdrew the refund demand based on the damaged comparison too. They may still ask someone else to manage the collection. I cannot buy that decision back. Tess, don't call for me. They deserve an answer in my voice, if they want one.

IF MURDERER: I killed Grant. The band did cross the stopper. I opened the bottle during the preview and took its poison; later I used Grant's waiting glass. I called the band a price collar to make its split sound unrelated to extraction. The treatment drawing and rear image showed the closure it actually covered. I had underpaid my relatives using a comparison I could not defend. Grant could show them both prices. I had paid the difference. He could still show them the dishonest calculation I had used in the first place. I paid the difference and still wanted to prevent them hearing what I'd done. Now they will hear this, and I can't manage how they respond.

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Justin Tyme

IF INNOCENT: I did not kill Grant. The later clipping corrects a name, not the contents. My current-theft headline left out a settlement I knew existed. The public correction and complete folder include it now. Anne, keep the old occupants in your tour. Keep the settlement too. If that takes longer than the dramatic version, we'll start earlier. I want people remembered even when their story doesn't give me a brilliant headline.

IF MURDERER: I killed Grant. The clipping has no neutralization record; its later correction concerns the earlier owner's name. The actual sale required original contents, and the seller fulfilled it. I took poison at the preview and used Grant's private glass. I invented a treatment in the archive to make the source harmless before tonight. He had the settlement I left out of my headline. I wanted people to remember the history I uncovered. They will remember the thing I invented to conceal a murder. The rest of the folder will have to survive me.

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Minnie Malist

IF INNOCENT: I did not kill Grant. Both styling copies cancel the hood, and the preparation image shows the bare glass. The hire credit reduced a bill I have accepted myself. The crew will be paid. Frank, leave the lights up. Brie, send the staff home. I don't need anyone to say the room looks wonderful. I need to stop trying to make that sentence the answer to everything.

IF MURDERER: I killed Grant. There was no hood protecting the waiting glass. The styling copies cross it out, and the preparation image shows the open place. I took poison at the preview and used that glass. I offered you my discarded design as protection that existed all evening. Grant could leave my crew unpaid and explain exactly whose promises had put them there. My crew made an evening people trusted me to manage. I made them work around a death I caused. Paying them cannot make that right.